

SHAN TANKHA

CITY-WISE RANKING

ARTS

- AHMEDABAD**
1. St. Xavier's College
 2. L.D. Arts College
 3. H.K. Arts College
 4. Vivekanand College
 5. Laxmiben & Chimanlal Mehta Arts College

- BANGALORE**
1. St. Joseph's College
 2. Christ College
 3. Mount Carmel College
 4. Jyoti Nivas College
 5. M.E.S. College of Arts, Science and Commerce

- CHENNAI**
1. Loyola College
 2. Madras Christian College
 3. Presidency College
 4. Stella Maris College
 5. Queen Mary's College

- KOCHI**
1. Sacred Heart College
 2. St. Albert's College
 3. St. Teresa's College
 4. Aquinas College
 5. The Cochin College

- CHANDIGARH**
1. D.A.V. College
 2. M.C.M. D.A.V. College for Women
 3. Guru Gobind Singh College for Women
 4. Govt College for Boys
 5. Govt College for Girls

- DELHI**
1. St. Stephen's College
 2. LSR College for Women
 3. Miranda House
 4. Hindu College
 5. Hansraj College

- HYDERABAD**
1. Loyola Academy
 2. University College for Women
 3. Nizam College
 4. A.V. College
 5. St. Francis College

- JAIPUR**
1. International College for Girls
 2. Kanodia Girls' College
 3. Agarwal College
 4. Maharani's College
 5. Subodh College

- KOLKATA**
1. St. Xavier's College
 2. Presidency College
 3. Loreto College
 4. Lady Brabourne College
 5. Scottish Church College

- LUCKNOW**
1. Isabella Thoburn College
 2. D.A.V. Degree College
 3. Faculty of Arts, Lucknow University
 4. Christian Degree College
 5. Mahila Vidyalaya College

- MUMBAI**
1. St. Xavier's College
 2. Sophia College
 3. Elphinstone College
 4. Mithibai College of Arts
 5. D.G. Ruparel College

- PUNE**
1. Fergusson College
 2. Symbiosis Society's College of Arts & Commerce
 3. Nowrojee Wadia College
 4. Modern College
 5. Bharati Vidyapeeth

For Delhi, Mumbai, Kolkata, Chennai, Bangalore and Hyderabad, the rankings are based on perceptual and factual scores. For Ahmedabad, Cochin, Chandigarh, Jaipur, Lucknow and Pune, the rankings are based on perceptual scores only.

INCHING CLOSE:
St. Stephen's,
Delhi has moved
up to No. 2

chess champion Viswanathan Anand, the Amritraj brothers and a string of Kollywood actors like Vijay, Vikram, Surya and Prabhu among its alumni.

Social commitments are largely fulfilled by the Rotaract Club of Loyola. In the aftermath of the tsunami, for instance, members of the 1,350-member club visited an island near Pulikat and helped in the rehabilitation process. Maruthi Pani Kumar, past president of Loyola College who currently works for Cognizant in Chennai, says: "I think the clinching factor in my job interview, in addition to my academic record, was the fact that I was at the helm of the Rotaract Club."

Similar to the Rotaract Club, the Loyola Theatre Society (LTS) is also abuzz with activity. It is currently

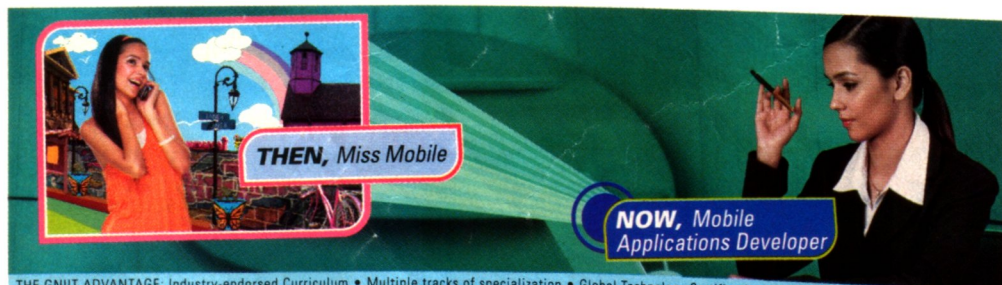
finalising scripts for the two plays it plans to stage this year. LTS is also celebrating its silver jubilee year and Father Joe Arun, who heads it, is gearing up to identify potential talent from the new batch of students joining in June. "More than providing a platform for students with histrionic talent to display their acting prowess, LTS also aims to enhance organisational abilities and crisis management," he explains. The plays, directed by former Loyolite Micheal Muthu, have been staged across leading venues in the city. "LTS was a major deciding factor for campus theatre," says Muthu, who was among its early entrants.

Arts departments in the other top colleges also provide balanced environment for intellectual and social growth. At St. Stephen's, the second ranker from Delhi, faculty members feel it is ingrained in the system. "Though it is difficult to zero in on any one variable, there is certainly an air of dedication and brilliance in every activity here," says

Rohit Wanchoo, head of the History Department. Classes and tutorials are characterised by a distinct rigour, with weekly seminars adding value to learning. A large pool of illustrious alumni, including heads of states, diplomats, scientists, writers and sportsmen, is regularly drawn upon for guest lectures. Moreover, 30-odd societies and 10 journals afford opportunities for students to express themselves.

Lady Shri Ram College—in the third place, up from No. 4 last year—makes it a point to encourage healthy co-ed interaction. "We haven't ghettoised our minds and we don't provide a cloistered orientation. To be global leaders, it is imperative for our students to have a comfort level with men and women alike," says principal Meenakshi Gopinath. In addition, the college provides unique facilities like mentorship programmes, placements with NGOs and multimedia teaching aides. Clearly, such features render these colleges a cut above the rest.

*with inputs from Kalf Mahmood
and Tanvi Saraf in Delhi*



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